

LANSING'S TOWN BOARD HAS TOLD ITS ATTORNEY TO DRAFT A DATA-CENTER BAN

778 GWh a year goes into the air.

That is the waste heat of Lake Hawkeye's 150 MW first phase. We found the terms under which Lansing can use it.

Thermal Commons [Heat for Lansing](#)

The heat is free. The town still might say no.

778 GWh

of heat a year leaves the 150 MW
first phase through dry coolers

No gas

Many homes burn propane and
oil; NYSEG has barred new gas
connections since Feb 2015 (2026
status unverified)

A ban

The Town Board told its attorney
to draft a data-center ban

Lansing, Michigan, 6 April 2026: Deep Green withdrew a heat-reuse data center after local opposition. Free heat was not enough.

OUR ANSWER: THE CONDITIONS UNDER WHICH LANSING CAN SAY YES

Don't ban it. Set the terms.

Binding contracts

Community Benefit Agreement
plus a Heat Supply Agreement
with step-in rights

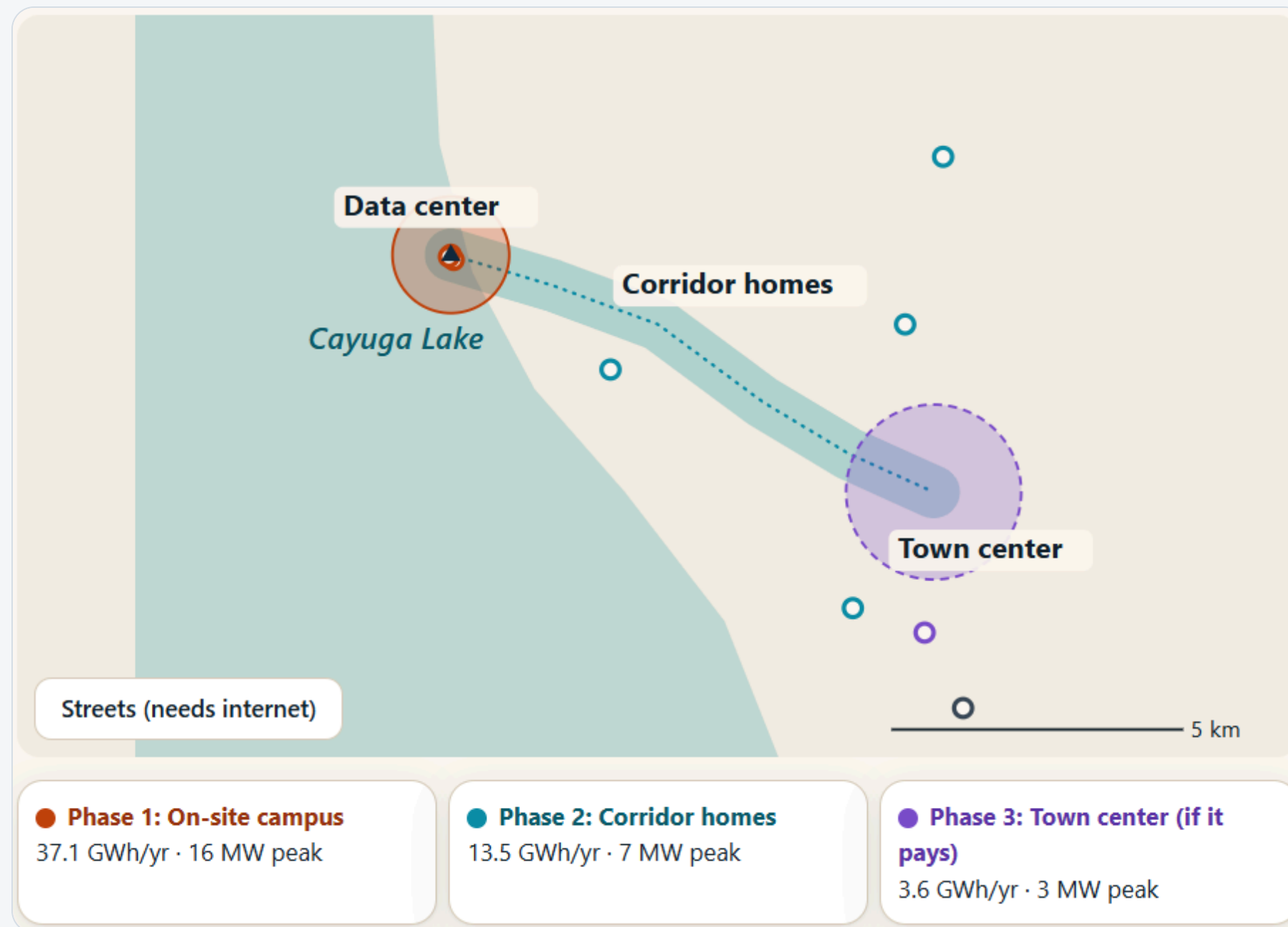
Community ownership

A thermal co-op owns the
network; the data center
supplies heat, not control

Public proof

An open dashboard reports heat
delivered, prices and CO2 every
month

The right tool at every density



1 · On-site campus

Greenhouse, fish, pool

\$41 / MWh Build

2 · Corridor

500 homes, ambient loop

\$286 / MWh Build with CBA funds

3 · Town center

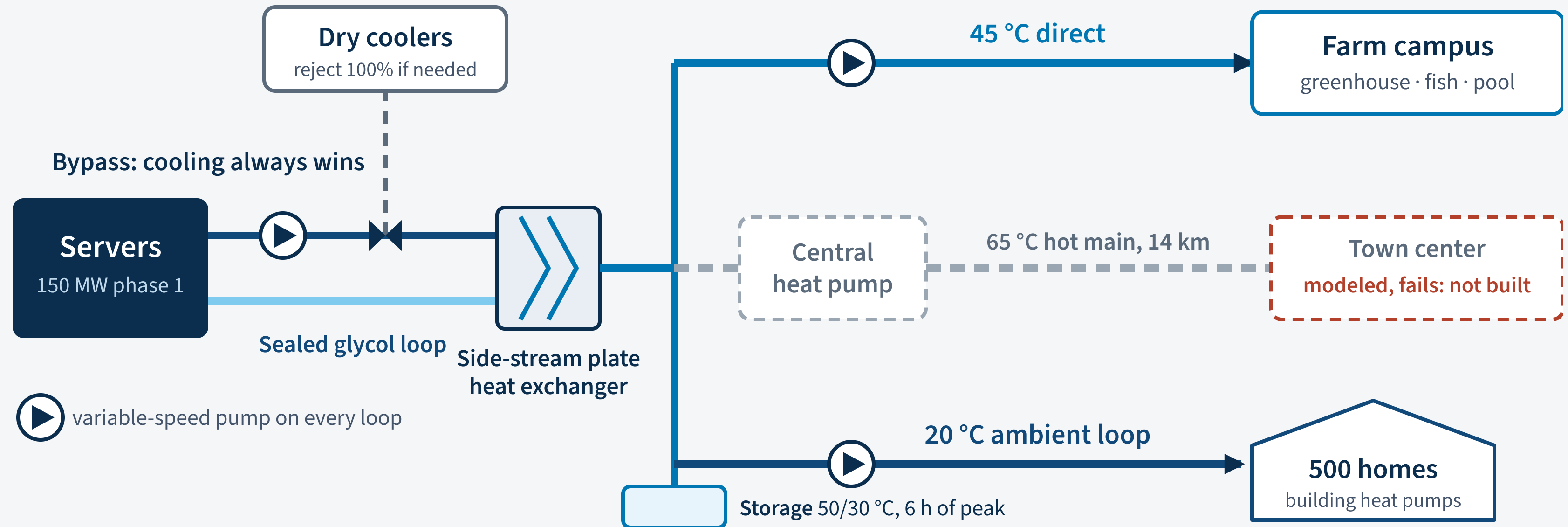
Hot main, 14 km

\$734 / MWh Fails: not built

Pipe goes only where heat density pays for it. Scattered homes get heat-pump rebates from the same community fund.

Levelized cost of heat at a 7% discount rate, 30 years. Map: Thermal Commons web app. Source: outputs/site2.json

How it works: every hour of the year



8,760-hour simulation on Ithaca typical-year weather, in an open Python model with tests. Backup boilers cover the peak.

$$\text{COP} = 0.5 \cdot T_{\text{sink}} / (T_{\text{sink}} - T_{\text{source}} + 6 \text{ K})$$

What it delivers, base case

\$735

a year off a propane bill

Typical home, 27 MWh a year. The tariff is set at 80% of propane, not at our cost. Vs oil: \$1,266.

50.6 GWh

heat delivered a year; 6.5% of the 778 GWh we can capture

\$106 / MWh

blended cost of heat vs propane \$136, oil \$156

11,408 t

CO2 avoided a year

THE HONEST PART

Pipe to scattered homes does not pay on its own. The community fund closes the gap.

~1.7%

of the build (an assumption-based estimate on a \$1.5B campus) funds the corridor gap and heat-pump rebates, through the Community Benefit Agreement

The on-site campus pays for itself.

A town-center main fails our own test, so we do not build it.

If the data center leaves, step-in rights and storage protect the co-op.

What Lansing gets

500

homes off propane and oil

4.6%

energy reuse factor, demand-limited:
6.5% of captured heat is used

126

local jobs

scenario estimate

5,500 t

food a year, 10 ha greenhouse

scenario estimate

1,500 t

fish a year, plus a year-round pool

scenario estimate

\$150k

a year for computer science in
Lansing's 3 public schools

proposed benefit-agreement term

Scored against seven regenerative domains: health, community, air, carbon, water, biodiversity and nutrients. We claim no lake water saved: the dry-cooler design is the developer's own.

Source: outputs/site2.json impact block (erf 0.0462); research/verification.md; school fund: docs/term-sheet.md 3.2 (proposal). Dashed cards are scenario estimates, not measurements.

Don't ban it. Set the terms.

1 · SIGN FIRST

**CBA and Heat
Supply Agreement
signed before site
approval**

2 · THE PRICE

1.7%

of the build. An assumption-
based estimate on a \$1.5B
campus.

3 · THE PAYOFF

\$735/yr

off a propane bill, per typical
home.

No one has signed yet. These are the terms we ask the Board to require.